

CHRONICLES SAGA — Team Board

Arinze (lead, minigames) · **Benjamin** (story, writer-programmer) · **Luca** (platform & integration)

This document exists so all three of us can see the *whole* project, not just our own lane. Read the parts that aren't yours — that's the point. Your work touches theirs in ways that aren't obvious from your own task list.

1. Where the project stands today

The story is finished and in the game. All twelve chapters — prologue through three endings — are written by Ben, converted, merged, and validating clean. 12 chapters, ~280 beats, three route-locked endings. `npm run validate` reports a fully playable graph with zero errors.

What already works:

- Phone OS: SMS, gallery, settings, lock screen, notifications
- Computer OS: email, files, terminal (hosts the Ch 5 decrypt minigame)
- Beat engine: sequential directives, natural message pacing, typing indicators, ghost messages that self-delete
- Trust (per character) and three alignment axes; trust-gated content and milestone photos
- Conditional branching on flags, patterns, visited beats, and trust thresholds
- Save/load with multiple slots and autosave
- Audio: BGM, SFX, volume control
- Season-one endgame mechanics: group membership changes, read receipts, inbox re-ordering, the Doubt composer effects

What's missing (the whole remaining board):

Area	Item	Owner	Severity
Endings	No ending screen — season end just stops playback	Luca	Defect — every player, every route
Ch 12	PC multi-feed interface unbuilt; endings play as chat + narration	Ben	Major presentation gap
Minigames	9 proposed, 1 exists	Arinze	Enhancement
Apps	Lens + Feeds don't exist yet	Arinze	Needed before games ship
Polish	Admin renders as - - - though it signs "admin" from Ch 8	Ben → Luca	Small
Polish	"admin is replying to..." is a system line, should be a quoted reply	Luca	Small
Polish	Prediction block (Ch 9/11) has no bespoke component	Luca	Small

Area	Item	Owner	Severity
QA	Nobody has played the game end to end	All three	Risk
Repo	~50 files uncommitted	Arinze	Do first

2. The three lanes

Each lane is a **whole system owned by one person**, not a stage in a pipeline. Nobody hands work to anybody. That's the point.

ARINZE — The minigame system (build *and* wire)

Owns the full vertical: the host apps, the games, and the wiring that puts them in the story.

- **Host + three apps** — extract the reusable host from `Terminal.jsx` (it already implements the whole contract for the Ch 5 decrypt), then point Terminal / Lens / Feeds at it
- **All ten games:**
 - *Hacking / terminal* — Ch 2 Frequency Trace · Ch 5 Voice Memo (*exists*) · Ch 8 Salvage · Ch 9 Sift · Ch 9 Relay Trace · Ch 12 Failsafe Assist
 - *Sight & perception* — Ch 6 Marker Watch · Ch 7 Verify
 - *Live tactical* — Ch 3 Pattern Read · Ch 12 Drone Work
- **Wiring** — converter support for the extended [MINIGAME] syntax, master-file blocks, convert, validate, play
- **Design language and failure-cost tuning** across all three families

Cadence: one or two games a week, each carried all the way to playable-in-story before the next begins.

BENJAMIN — Chapter 12 endgame

The endings are written and in the game; their *presentation* was never specified. He wrote them, so he defines them.

- **PC multi-feed interface** — spec first (4-5 cam panels, feeds going dark, how the layout differs across the three endings), then build if tooling allows. Largest undefined thing in the project
- **Three ending screens** — the copy Luca's frame will hold
- **Admin voice call** — --- or admin from Ch 8 onward
- **Minigame proposal verdict** — he has veto
- **Seam lines** — reviewed in batches, not authored from scratch (see below)
- **Chapter 13** — open whenever he wants it

LUCA — Interface & polish

Independent of the minigame system entirely, so nothing in his lane waits on a game existing.

- **Hosted build for Ben** — one hour, unblocks Ben's entire lane
- **Ending screen** — the one live defect; frame now, Ben's copy later
- **Presentation polish** — quoted-reply bubble, Admin display name, prediction block (Ch 9/11)

- **The bug list** — he's the closest thing to QA; plays every chapter as it lands
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3. How the lanes interlock

Very little, deliberately. What connections remain:

LUCA's hosted build —→ unblocks BEN entirely (1 hour, do it first)

ARINZE drafts seam lines → BEN rewrites in batches → ARINZE drops them in
(never blocking in either direction)

BEN's ending copy —→ LUCA's ending screen frame (frame built without it)

BEN's Ch 12 spec —→ built by BEN, or LUCA if tooling doesn't allow

Practical consequences:

- **A minigame is done when Arinze says it's done.** Build, wire, validate, play — one person, one slice, no handoff. This is the biggest change from the earlier plan and the reason the cadence is realistic.
 - **Seam dialogue never blocks.** Arinze writes placeholder lines in Ben's voice while he's already in the master file; Ben rewrites them in batches of two or three whenever it suits him. Placeholders ship if they have to.
 - **Luca builds frames, not contents.** The ending screen gets built empty and filled when Ben's copy arrives.
 - **Nobody hand-edits story.json.** See §5.
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4. Roadmap

Step 0 — today (Arinze, 10 min). Commit the working tree. Everything below assumes a clean base.

Step 1 — this week: all three play the full season. Separately, start to finish, taking notes. This is the highest-value thing the team can do right now and it costs a day. We have a finished twelve-chapter game that none of us has experienced end to end; every priority call below gets sharper afterward, and the minigame slots in particular should be confirmed against where the pacing *actually* sags.

Step 2 — close the defect. Ending screen, plus whatever the playthrough surfaces. At this point Season One is complete and shippable on its own terms.

Step 3 — three independent tracks open. - **Arinze:** generalise the host out of Terminal.jsx → Marker Watch → wire it end to end. That first complete slice proves the pipeline; everything after is the same five steps. - **Luca:** ending screen frame → presentation polish → bug list. - **Ben:** proposal verdict → Ch 12 feed interface spec → ending copy.

Step 4 — cadence. Arinze at one to two games a week in whatever order the playthrough justified (Terminal family batches fastest). Ben's Ch 12 work and Luca's polish run alongside at their own pace.

5. Working agreements

The minigame contract still stands — docs/MINIGAME_CONTRACT.md. A game is a pure component taking config, timeLeft, onResolve; games never touch the engine, advance beats, write flags, or run their own timer. Arinze now owns both sides of it, so it's no longer a coordination device between two people — it's his own discipline. Keep it anyway: ten games that all resolve the same way are ten games that can be re-tuned, re-ordered, or cut without touching the host.

File ownership (this is what keeps concurrent work from turning into merge hell):

- **Arinze** — src/screens/minigames/*, Terminal.jsx, the Lens and Feeds apps, scripts/convert-story.js, and [MINIGAME] blocks in the CH masters
- **Luca** — ending screen, SMSApp.jsx, phone/desktop UI, presentation components
- **Ben** — documents; the Ch 12 feed interface if he builds it
- **Touched by two people:** ComputerHome (Arinze registers apps, Luca styles) and engine.js (rare, small). Shout before either.

story.json is a build artifact. 13k generated lines; hand-merging it is misery. Never edit directly. On any conflict, take either side wholesale and re-run the converter over all masters. Masters are the only source of truth.

Branches: feat/minigames, feat/platform, story/seams. Rebase onto main often — the file split keeps rebases clean.

6. Open calls (10 minutes, then everyone proceeds)

1. **App names** — recommend **Terminal / Lens / Feeds**. Terminal already exists in-fiction; Feeds' shell becomes the Ch 12 interface.
2. **Idle screens** — recommend blank plus one dormant line (NO ACTIVE READ / NO LIVE FEED / blinking cursor) so the apps read as dormant rather than broken.

Neither blocks a start.